

PART A: Diagnosis
What's actually going on?

Read the three situations below. For each one, answer:

SITUATION A: The Alert Nobody Responds To

Stated Problem:

The Unified tracker shows department names, not individuals. There's no daily micro-plan. Complex tasks aren't minimized to smaller tasks.

What's Actually Going On:

The tracker is a visibility tool, not an accountability system. It tells you what is late, but not who owns it, why it's late, or what happens next. The absence of daily planning compounds this. Without a micro-plan, there's no baseline to measure deviation against. Everything becomes "normal" because there's no explicit expectation to deviate from. The organization is managing by exception, but can't see exceptions because it never defined the rule. The CEO finds the status "Red" everywhere and no one escalates them. As Karthik and Anil states they sends the report everyday but don't know why they don't act on it.

Evidence:

If I see 'Warehouse, delayed,' who feels the pressure? Nobody.
Complex tasks like "Release a Purchase Order" (5-6 steps across multiple people) appear as a single line item with one due date—no visibility into who dropped which step.
No daily micro-plan exists. When asked how they identify unplanned work: If there's no plan for today, everything is unplanned.

Situation B: The Blank Field

Stated Problem:

People don't fill in root cause fields. Management says it's a discipline issue: "We keep reminding them but they don't do it."

What's Actually Going On:

It's not a discipline problem—it's a safety problem. Honesty is being punished. When supervisors write real root causes, they get publicly interrogated or see colleagues humiliated.
The deviation tracker isn't broken as software. It's broken as a social contract. The organization is asking for transparency in a culture that penalizes it. Until consequence for honest disclosure is removed (or reversed), the data will remain useless. It is their unrealistic behavior towards their work which implies they are not determined to escalate it. The column in the tracker identifies the "Root Column" as blank, will be investigated, vendor issue, process deviation, preventive maintenance not done, etc. And after certain accusations no one is able to solve them.

Evidence:

70% of root cause fields are blank or generic.
Supervisor 1: "If I write what actually went wrong... it becomes a blame game. So I leave it blank and handle it quietly."
Supervisor 2: "Last time I wrote the real root cause... the maintenance head got called out in front of everyone. After that, nobody writes root cause honestly."

Management's framing ("people are not disciplined enough") directly contradicts the supervisors' testimony—indicating leadership is either unaware of or unwilling to acknowledge the real dynamic.

SITUATION C: The Daily Meeting Status

Stated Problem:

The meeting is scheduled for 30 minutes but runs 60–90 minutes. There's not enough time for 12 people to report, and unrelated technical issues get discussed, generating unplanned work.

What's Actually Going On:

The meeting has no defined scope or decision-rights structure. Technical problems (like out-of-spec lab results) surface here because there's no escalation pathway or parallel process to handle them. The meeting isn't too long—it's carrying weight it was never designed to carry. Also, not be able to look forward what the problem is, nobody knows where it should be discussed, who decides or what the outcome would be. Not managing proper Time Management for the scheduled meeting on a particular day.

Evidence:

Technical Issues from departments are discussed in such a manner in which it has no pathway instead of being routed in a single meeting. The output of the meeting generates unplanned and unfinished work at the end of the day.

The advisor's math ($12 \times 10 = 120$ minutes) was met with silence—nobody had ever done this calculation, suggesting the meeting's structure was never intentionally designed.